

Brick Title (as it will appear in the menu) : Thinking in English

☐ NEW BRICK ☒ Revamp of existing brick:Thinking in English.....

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Menu	Sub-topic	KEYWORDS (for the search engine: 3-5 words)
☐ Everyday Communication ☐ Specialist Communication ☐ Professional Communication ☒ Learning Focus	☒ Existant ☐ To be createdLearning Strategies.....	Fluency Spontaneity

Content	Comments/instructions for David
 <u>Step 1: Introduction</u> LEARNING OBJECTIVES At the end of this brick you will be able to put in practice some methods for training yourself to think in English. CONTENT You will ... 1) Reflect on your current relationship with English, with the help of a short quiz 2) Watch a short video 3) Practise some methods to train yourself to think in English 4) Check your pronunciation of new words 5) Prepare some work to share with your teacher or your classmates 6) You can explore the subject further using the resources provided if you wish TIME: Brick – approximately 25 minutes Further, regular practice of exercises recommended CEFR level: A2	
<u>Step 2: I start – thinking in English</u> You may think that being able to think in a language other than your native language is a sign of fluency, only available to advanced learners. But this is	Pas de faux réponse: il faut qu'ils puisse tout sélectionner, et ils ne

not the case: in fact, you can train yourself to think in English at any level, as a method of improving your language awareness and use. Complete this short quiz to help you reflect on how you currently work on English mentally. Q1. Have you ever found yourself thinking in English? a) Yes b) No Q2. Have you ever made the effort to think in English, as part of the learning process? a) No, never b) I tried it once or twice because the teacher told me to c) It's something I try to do regularly Q3. When you want to speak aloud in English, do you a) Think of what you want to say in your native language, then translate b) Try to move from thought to speech in English c) Give up and keep quiet because it's too difficult Q4. When speaking English with others, what worries you the most? a) Vocabulary b) Sentence structure c) Pronunciation Q5. How do you practise speaking English? (More than one answer is possible) a) With fellow learners during class time b) During social occasions with English speakers c) Talking to yourself d) Talking to yourself in your head	reçoivent pas de vrai « score » (Comme dans « Memorising vocabulary »)
Step 3: I learn – to think in English	
<i>I learn (option 3)</i> <i>Video ("watch&listen")</i>  https://youtu.be/wY2zyhDgeto?si=WqCJ0HgE2T7Ayg6F Watch the first part of the video (0:00-3:56) and try the two exercises described. Hints: Exercise 1 – look around the room you are currently in, and try to find the English word for as many things you can see as possible. Exercise 2 – formulate simple sentences or questions about what you can see around you.	Est-ce que c'est possible que la section « Hints » apparaisse sur click, comme rappel une fois qu'ils ont fini la vidéo ? Ou est-ce que je dois mettre ces 2 choses dans un « Summary » ?

Step 5: I practise



“Language work”

Choose one of the pictures below, and use the exercises below to think in English about what you see.

- 1) Pick out objects in the image and check you know the English word for them
- 2) Describe the scene of the picture in simple sentences.
- 3) Imagine yourself in the scene of the picture, and describe what you can see, hear, or smell, how you feel, and what you think is going to happen.

Insert images here

It is important to practise this type of exercise regularly if possible.

- Select an image from any handy magazine, book or electronic device, and apply the 3 exercises above.
- Take the time in your daily routine to observe your surroundings (when on public transport, for example), identify objects in English and think about sentences to describe what you see.

Images dans dossier
“Thinking in English – I
practise images”
*Si jamais le fait que les
images ne sont pas tous le
même orientation pose
problème, je peux choisir
d’autres OU on peut
redistribuer les images
choisi pour I practise et I do.*

Step 6: I say



“Voicework”

Look again at one of the images you used in the “I practise” section, and note down the words you identified in step 1. Say them aloud – are you sure you are pronouncing them correctly? Check your pronunciation using an online dictionary – many entries will include audio recordings of the word.

<https://www.wordreference.com/>
<https://dictionary.cambridge.org/dictionary/english/>

Step 8: I do



“Autonomy”

Choose from the exercises below, or complete the exercise(s) allocated by your Boost’English teacher.

Option 1 – talk about a picture

Choose one of the images below, and recording yourself speaking about it for 30 seconds. To do this, do one of the following:

- 1) Describe what you see in the picture
- 2) Imagine yourself in the scene in the picture: what do you see, hear, sense? How do you feel? What do you think is going to happen next?

Insert images here

Option 2 – keep a journal

Images dans dossier
“Thinking in English – I do
images”

Journaling is another great way to encourage yourself to think in English. Try keeping a short daily journal in English – writing about what happened today, what you learned, or just how you feel. Submit it to your teacher if required. <u>Option 3 – reflection</u> Try to use the exercises in this brick to think in English regularly, over the course of a week (or other time period defined by your teacher). Write a short paragraph (around 100 words) reporting and reflecting on your experience. Some questions to help your reflection: <i>Was it difficult to get started? Did it get easier as you repeated the exercise? Did you find yourself thinking in English at any point outside of the exercises?</i>	
Step 9: I share  “groupclass” Select a picture to share with your classmates, and bring it to class. Think about the vocabulary needed to describe the picture. In class, you will try describing the picture brought by one of your classmates, and share your chosen picture to be described by another student. Use your prepared vocabulary to check how well they do, and teach them any words they are missing.	
Step 10: I want more • rachelawan. 2024. ‘Train Your Brain to Think in Another Language FluentU Language Blog’. FluentU, February 13. https://www.fluentu.com/blog/learn/thinking-in-a-foreign-language/.	
Step 11: For teachers <u>Pair/group activity</u> Provide printouts or flashcards of further striking images, for students to: • Describe to each other • Imagine they are part of the scene – to talk about what they see, hear, feel and what happens next • Improvise a story based on the content of the image. If working in groups, students can take it in turns to continue the story (with or without prompts from further images – this exercise works well with image cards from games such as Dixit). The above activities can be converted into writing activities as required. <u>Speaking activity</u>	Cachée pour les étudiants

Student A describes a scene (what they see, hear, feel) and Student B has to guess where the scene takes place (ex. at school, at the cafet, etc).	
Summaries in downloadable format <i>Use the template Brick SUMMARY - model doc.docx available in the “Brick downloadable summaries” folder on the cloud. You may have to install the Lexend font set (chosen for its readability and accessibility). Check that the font is retained when you convert the document to pdf!</i>	NOT APPLICABLE pour cette brique